

The Goodnight Zoo

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Miko the meerkat could not sleep. His burrow was too quiet. He missed the sounds of the zoo where he lived. He missed his animal friends.

He tiptoed out of his burrow. The zoo was silver with moonlight. "I will say goodnight to everyone," he decided. "Then I will feel sleepy."

First he visited Gina the giraffe. She was already lying down, which looked very funny. Her long neck was curled like a slide. "Goodnight, Gina," whispered Miko.



"Goodnight, sleep tight," yawned Gina.

Next he visited Lenny the lion. Lenny opened his huge mouth wide. Miko felt a little scared. But it was only a yawn! A great big sleepy yawn.

"Goodnight, Lenny," whispered Miko.

"Goodnight, sleep tight," rumbled Lenny softly.

Then he visited Penny the penguin. She was tucked into a pile of soft snow. Her flippers were folded like hands in prayer. "Goodnight, Penny," whispered Miko.

"Goodnight, sleep tight," peeped Penny.



Miko visited the sleepy elephants. He visited the drowsy zebras. He visited the yawning hippo, whose yawn was the biggest of all. Each animal was cozy in bed. Miko felt sleepier with every goodnight.

"Goodnight, sleep tight," he whispered to the whole zoo.

He scurried back to his own burrow. It did not feel too quiet anymore. It felt peaceful, like the rest of the zoo. He curled into his warm sand bed.

"Goodnight, sleep tight," he whispered to himself.



His mother tucked the blanket around him. "Did you say goodnight to everyone?" she asked.

"Everyone," said Miko proudly. Then he yawned the biggest meerkat yawn ever. His eyes closed all by themselves.

"Goodnight, sleep tight," his mother whispered one last time.

The zoo was silent now. Gina dreamed of tall trees. Lenny dreamed of soft clouds. Penny dreamed of snowflakes. And Miko dreamed he was the goodnight keeper of the whole zoo.

Sleep now, little meerkat. You said goodnight to every friend. Now it is your turn to dream.

Moral: *Saying goodnight with love makes bedtime feel warm and complete.*

The End